

BRAND GUIDELINES · MAKARIOS MARKETING

Duality *Salon*

A mother and daughter, two generations of one craft, and a room that is soft and industrial at once. This is how the brand looks, reads and photographs.

CLIENT

Duality Salon

LOCATION

Williamsville, NY

CONTACT

Sue Dicky

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01 THE IDEA

The name is the *whole strategy*.

We do not need to invent this. The salon already says it, in their own words.

*Beautiful style is achieved through mastery of contrasting elements:
dark and light, wavy and straight, dynamic and still.*

DUALITY SALON

That line is the brand strategy, and it belongs somewhere prominent on the new site. Everything in this document is that idea applied. It is true of the salon three times over: Sue and Leah are mother and daughter, the room is soft and industrial at once, and the work is both technical precision and personal care.

Soft

Warm, personal, unhurried. The half that makes someone feel looked after.

Sand and ivory grounds, brass warmth

Cormorant Garamond, light and high contrast

Natural window light, skin tones, texture

Language about conversation and care

Industrial

Clean, precise, confident. The half that says these people know exactly what they are doing.

Ink grounds and hairline rules

Jost, geometric and even in colour

Straight edges, generous space, no clutter

Language about precision and craft

Use both on every surface. All soft goes generic salon. All industrial goes cold. The tension between them is the brand.

02 POSITIONING

Sue and Leah, *front and centre*.

The client's own direction, and the right one. Most salon sites lead with a stock photo of hair. This one leads with two named people and a family story, which is the one thing competitors cannot copy.

Sue is Artistic Director, with four decades behind the chair and a background as a L'ANZA educator training stylists up and down the East Coast. Leah is the owner. She grew up in it and now leads the education side. That hand-off between generations is the story both the homepage and the About page should carry.

Three proof points the build already uses well, all worth protecting: **100+ years of combined experience** across five stylists, **established 2020** in Williamsville, and the promise that the salon **never overbooks**. That last one is the strongest thing on the page, because it is a specific operational commitment rather than an adjective.

LEAD WITH

Named stylists with real faces

The mother and daughter thread

Never overbooking, stated plainly

Education, and the L'ANZA roots

Long-standing client relationships

AVOID

Stock salon photography of any kind

Luxury filler such as pamper or indulge

Leading with price or promotions

Anonymous "our team of experts"

Exclamation marks anywhere

03 COLOUR

Warm ground, ink *structure*, one brass accent.

These are the tokens already in the build. Sand and ivory carry the soft half and should cover most of any page. Ink carries the industrial half and does the structural work. Brass is the only accent, and it is used sparingly.

Worth noting: the sand ground is almost exactly the salon's own wall colour, and the brass matches the woven pendant lights. The palette was read from the room, not chosen for it.

Sand

#EFE8DE

--sand

Page ground. The salon's wall colour.

Ivory

#F8F4EE

--ivory

Panels that lift off the sand.

Line

#E3DACD

--line

Hairlines and dividers. One weight.

Brass

#8C6D43

--brass

The one accent. Buttons, rules, large type.

Brass Deep

#6F5433

--brass-deep

Links and small accent type on light grounds.

Brass Light

#C9AF86

--brass-lt

Accent on dark only. Never on sand.

Ink

#161412

--ink

Body text, and the team's black.

Stone

#72695F

--stone

Secondary text and labels.

SAND ON INK

15.4 : 1 · safe at any size

INK ON SAND

15.4 : 1 · the default reading pair

BRASS ON SAND

3.9 : 1 · large text and buttons only

BRASS DEEP ON SAND

5.8 : 1 · use for links and small type

04 TYPOGRAPHY

One serif with warmth, one sans with *discipline*.

The pairing carries the duality without anyone having to explain it. Cormorant Garamond is elegant, high contrast and soft. Jost is geometric, even and clean. Headlines in one, everything functional in the other, and never the reverse.

DISPLAY · CORMORANT GARAMOND · 300 / 400 · ROMAN AND ITALIC

Colour, style and *self-care* in Williamsville

Headlines, stylist names, pull quotes. Cormorant is light and high contrast, so it needs size and air to work. Never below 20px, and the italic carries one emphasised word rather than a whole line.

INTERFACE · JOST · 200 TO 500

Book an appointment · Curly and textured hair · Hand-tied extensions · Balayage and dimensional colour · Wednesday to Saturday

Navigation, buttons, labels, body copy, forms, captions. Jost is even in colour, which is what keeps the pages feeling clean next to the serif. Uppercase labels take 0.28em tracking. Body copy never drops below 16px, and weight 300 is for large text only.

DISPLAY

Cormorant 300 · 58 / 0.9

SECTION

Cormorant 300 · 42 / 1.1

NAME

Cormorant 400 · 28 / 1.1

LEDE

Jost 300 · 19 / 1.8

BODY

Jost 400 · 16.5 / 1.75

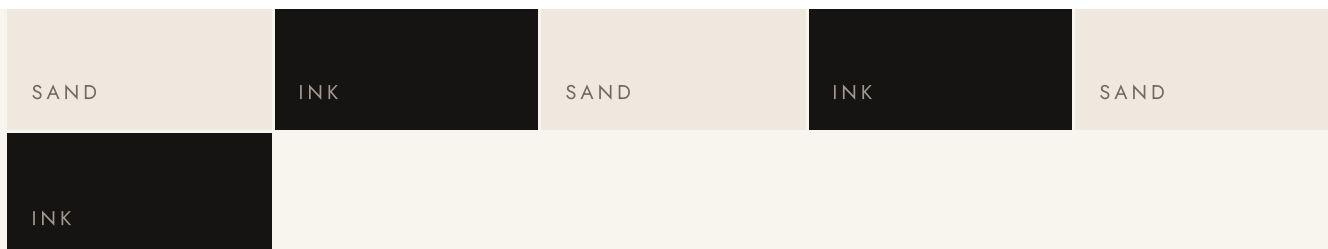
LABEL

JOST 400 · 11 / UPPERCASE

05 LAYOUT

The page alternates, *the way the brand does*.

The single most important structural rule in the build is the band rhythm. Cream section, then ink section, then cream again, the whole way down. That is not decoration. It is the soft and industrial pairing made structural, so the page performs the brand idea rather than describing it.



Two rules keep it working. Never place two ink bands next to each other, and give every band enough vertical padding that the alternation reads as deliberate rather than stripey. Dark bands carry the moments that need weight: pricing, the never-overbook promise, education, and the closing call to action.

Recurring devices

The brass seal

GRAPHIC DEVICE

The circular monogram works as a stamp on dark bands, set large and low in opacity behind content, or small and solid as a badge. Use it once per band at most. It is the only ornament the brand needs.

Italic emphasis

HEADLINE PATTERN

Every section headline italicises one phrase in Cormorant: *a thoughtful conversation, the Duality team, have to say*. One phrase per headline, never two, and never a whole line. It is what makes the headings feel written rather than assembled.

Eyebrow label

SECTION MARKER

A small-caps Jost label sits above every section heading, tracked wide in stone or brass. It gives the long page structure without adding rules everywhere.

The offset card

IMAGE TREATMENT

A cream card overlapping the edge of a photograph, as used on the mother and daughter block. It softens a hard photo edge and is the one place the layout breaks its own grid. Keep it rare, two or three times across a page.

The price ledger

PRICING PATTERN

Service name left, price right, hairline between rows. No boxes, no badges, no strikethroughs. Honest pricing presented plainly is the point, and it is reinforced by the line about the stylist confirming the final price at consultation.

The step row

PROCESS PATTERN

Four steps across, separated by hairlines rather than arrows or numbers in circles. Book, consultation, service, at-home care. Numbers stay small and in brass.

Full-bleed photo strip

GALLERY PATTERN

Four images edge to edge with no gaps, running the full width. It gives the page a breath between reading sections and shows the room without a formal gallery.

BUTTONS

Primary: solid ink, ivory text, no radius

Secondary: hairline outline, brass text

On ink bands: hairline outline, ivory text

Labels in Jost, tracked, sentence case

SPACING

Band padding scales with viewport, never fixed

One hairline weight across the whole site

Gaps of 2px between colour blocks, not 20px

Let whitespace separate, not borders

06 PHOTOGRAPHY

Real room, real people, *real light*.

The room does the brand's work already. Warm cream walls and woven drum pendants set against a blacked-out ceiling and exposed ductwork, with live plants softening every corner and warm wood underfoot. That is the soft-and-industrial idea, built. Shoot it as it is, and keep the ceiling in frame on wider shots, because it is the industrial half of the palette.

The team wears **all black** in every photo, which reads as deliberate and should stay that way. It keeps group shots clean and lets the warm room and the hair carry the colour.

Of everything supplied, the education-class photo is the most valuable. Every stylist's bio claims ongoing training, and that one image proves it rather than stating it.

DO

Shoot in the salon, in its own light

Portraits at eye level, relaxed, to camera

Hands working, tools in frame

Leave space for type to sit

Keep skin tones warm and true

DON'T

Heavy filters or cool blue grading

Stock imagery, even as placeholder

Tight crops with no breathing room

Busy backgrounds fighting the subject

Mixed portrait styles on one page

One rule for the team page: every portrait shot the same way, same distance, same background treatment. Mismatched portraits are the fastest way to make a good team look unserious.

07 VOICE

Expert, warm, and never *salesy*.

The site already has the right instinct with lines like "every great style begins with a thoughtful conversation." Keep it. Write the way Sue or Leah would talk to someone in the chair: confident about the craft, genuinely interested in the person.

SOUNDS LIKE DUALITY

"Every great style begins with a thoughtful conversation."

"We never overbook. Ever."

"We'll tell you what will actually work with your hair."

"Curly hair is its own craft, and we've trained for it."

DOESN'T

"Indulge in the ultimate pampering experience."

"Transform your look today!"

"Book now and save 20%."

"Our team of beauty professionals."

08 THE TEAM

Bios for the new *About* page.

Tightened from the copy the salon supplied, kept in their own facts and their own warmth. Sue and Leah lead, as requested. Each one closes on something personal, which is what makes a team page worth reading.

ARTISTIC DIRECTOR · MOTHER

Sue Dicky

40 years behind the chair

Sue has spent four decades behind the chair and most of that time teaching other people how to do it well. She travelled the East Coast as a L'ANZA educator, training and inspiring stylists along the way, and she still hosts classes here at the salon.

What she values most is the clients she has known for years. Outside the salon you will find her sewing a new project or volunteering with her church's children's program.

OWNER & STYLIST ·
DAUGHTER

Leah Blachaniec

Behind the chair since
2013

Leah is the daughter of a lifelong stylist, so you could fairly say this is in her DNA. She grew up surrounded by the work and turned that into salon ownership, and she has spent six years building the team here.

She leads on continued education, which is how the whole salon keeps getting better. Away from work she is caring for her houseplants, tending a small summer garden, and baking.

STYLIST

Amanda Pohlman

Almost 20 years in the
industry

Amanda followed her dreams into hairstyling in her thirties and has been growing her craft ever since. She loves a polished blowout that shows off the colour and the cut underneath, and she has taken class after class to keep refining her technique alongside the rest of the team.

When she is not at the salon she is travelling with her husband or spending time with family.

STYLIST

Darcy Ragione

Nearly 30 years in the
industry

Darcy grew up watching her grandmother give perms, and that is what pulled her into hairstyling. She builds custom cuts and styles around each client rather than working from a template.

She is a regular in the classroom, sharing ideas with other stylists and bringing new techniques back to her clients, and she continues her education here at the salon. Outside work she is at the gym or with her pups.

STYLIST · CURLS &
VIVIDS

Marianna Campione

Creating hair magic since
2023

Marianna is a curly girl herself, which is exactly why clients trust her with their natural texture. She helps people stop fighting their curls and start feeling confident in them, and she loves the creative side of vivid colour.

She is deep into learning every hair type and texture there is, with more classes booked. Away from the salon she travels and gets lost in a good book.

09 ASSETS

What we have, what *needs work*.

Ten photos sit in the SEO drive. Before any go on the site the filenames need fixing, because WordPress builds image URLs straight from them.

FILE IN DRIVE	USE	RENAME TO
Sue & Leah #2.jpg	About hero, homepage story block	sue-leah-duality-salon-williamsville.jpg
Sue Dicky.jpg	Team portrait	sue-dicky-artistic-director.jpg
Leah Blachaniec.jpg	Team portrait	leah-blachaniec-owner-stylist.jpg
Amanda Pohlman.jpg	Team portrait	amanda-pohlman-stylist.jpg
Marianna Campione.jpg	Team portrait, colour version	marianna-campione-curl-specialist.jpg
Mairanna.jpg TYPO	Black and white duplicate. Drop it.	consolidate
Group picture .jpg / #2 / #3	Homepage, About, footer band	duality-salon-team-williamsville-ny.jpg
Staff taking an educational class.jpg	Proof for the education claim. Use prominently.	duality-salon-continuing-education.jpg

Every file is between 3 MB and 9 MB. Compress to roughly 200 to 400 KB before upload, and write alt text per image describing the person and the salon, not just "stylist". Darcy has no photo in the set, and the build already marks hers "coming soon".

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 Brand guidelines prepared by Makarios Marketing.